

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DPS

Date: 5/15/2026

Bill Number: HB 93

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): RESIDENCY REQ: HUNTING, TRAPPING, FISHING

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☒ SIGN ☐ VETO ☐ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

If enacted, the bill would make residency enforcement for hunting, trapping, and fishing easier for the Alaska Wildlife Troopers. The division would continue enforcing residency requirements related to hunting, trapping, and fishing privileges. The bill provides additional statutory criteria and regulatory authority that may assist troopers and the department in verifying residency eligibility during investigations and contacts.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

The bill modifies AS 16.05.400 and AS 16.05.415 by adding new requirements that a person:

Must be physically present in Alaska during the entire 12-month residency period before applying for a resident license, unless their absence qualifies under the Permanent Fund

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Dividend allowable absence statute (AS 43.23.008).

The bill also applies these same standards to non-citizen residents (“resident alien”) seeking resident licenses.

Requires ADF&G to adopt regulations establishing how resident eligibility is determined. Explicitly authorizes the commissioner to require documentation and use information from other state agencies to verify eligibility.

Clarifies that holders of permanent identification cards for free licenses must continue meeting residency requirements after issuance.

The effective date is January 1, 2028.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1 amends [AS 16.05.400](#) *Persons exempt from annual licensing requirements*

Amends AS 16.05.400 by adding a new subsection (d) requiring that a person issued a permanent identification card for hunting, trapping, or sport fishing privileges must continue to meet the residency requirements established in AS 16.05.415 in order to use the identification card

Section 2 amends [AS 16.05.415\(a\)](#) *Determination of residency*

Amends the resident eligibility requirements for hunting, trapping, and sport fishing licenses by requiring an applicant to:

- be physically present in Alaska with intent to remain indefinitely and make a home in the state;
- maintain domicile in Alaska for the 12 consecutive months preceding application;
- **NEW:** be physically present in Alaska during that 12-month period unless absent only for reasons permitted under [AS 43.23.008](#) *Allowable absences*;
- not claim residency in another state, territory, or country; and
- not obtain benefits under a claim of residency in another state, territory, or country.

Section 3 — [AS 16.05.415\(e\)](#) *Determination of residency* Amends residency qualifications applicable to non-citizens (“ealiens”) seeking resident hunting, trapping, and sport fishing licenses by applying the same physical presence, domicile, residency, and benefit restrictions established in Section 2 of the bill.

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Section 4 — [AS 16.05.415](#) Commissioner authority and regulations

Adds a new subsection (j) authorizing the commissioner to adopt regulations under the Administrative Procedure Act to determine resident license eligibility. Authorizes the commissioner to require proof of eligibility, use information available from other state departments or agencies, and consider all relevant circumstances when determining whether an individual qualifies as a resident for licensure purposes.

Section 5 — Effective date

Provides for an effective date of January 1, 2028.

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

N/A

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

[HB 93 SRES Public Testimony 5.12.26.pdf](#)

[HB 93 Testimony SRES 5.4.26.pdf](#)

[HB 93 Testimony - Received by 3.24.26.pdf](#)

[HB 93 Letters of Opposition received as of 3.23.26.pdf](#)

[HB 93 Letters of Support received as of 3.23.26.pdf](#)

[HB 93 Testimony to Amend- John Joyce 3.16.26.pdf](#)

Support

- Paul Johnson, Juneau
- Matt Snyder
- The “Four Tribes”:
 - Craig Tribal Association,
 - Klawock Cooperative Association,
 - Hydaburg Cooperative Association,
 - Organized Village of Kasaan
- Jacob Combs, Tok
- Lantz Dahlke, North Pole
- Elic Kirby
- Robert Sellers

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- Averie Wells, Government Relations Manager, Native Peoples Action (NPA)
- Alaska Regional Coalition:
 - Tanana Chiefs Conference (TCC),
 - Maniilaq Association,
 - Iñupiat Community of the Arctic Slope (ICAS),
 - Chugachmiut,
 - Kawerak Inc.,
 - Central Council of Tlingit & Haida Indian Tribes of Alaska, and
 - the Association of Village Council Presidents (AVCP)
- Jake Fletcher, Chairman, Alaska Board of Game
- Benjamin Mallott, President, Alaska Federation of Natives
- Patrick Baum, Chair, Elfin Cove Fish and Game Advisory Committee
- Stacey Wayne, Chair, Sitka Fish and Game Advisory Committee
- Lolanda Cavanaugh, Mayor, City of Kake
- Kevin Taylor, Chairperson, Anchorage Fish and Game Advisory Committee
- Larry N. Carson, Pelican
- Shirley Perkins
- Alliance of Sovereign Tribes of Southeast Alaska
- Douglas Malone, Chairman, Homer ADFG Advisory Committee
- Tami Mulick, Juneau
- Lance Kronberger, Freelance Outdoor Adventures
- Cabot Pitts, Palmer
- R. Seal
- Steve Miller, Port & Harbor Director, City and Borough of Wrangell
- Mike Wood, Board of Fisheries Member
- Kurt Whitehead, Treasure Hunter Lodge LLC, Klawock
- Kasey Smith, Mayor, City of Craig
- Ellen Hannan, Chair of Craig Fish and Game Advisory Committee
- City of Coffman Cove
- Scott Newman, Petersburg Flying Service LLC, Assemblymember, Petersburg Borough Assembly
- Joseph Johnson
- Brian Castle
- Richard Peterson, Central Council of Tlingit & Haida Tribes of Alaska
- Chris Guggenbickler, Chairperson, Wrangell Fish and Game Advisory Committee
- Mary Corcoran, Delta Junction
- Vern Aiton, Delta Sportsman's Association
- Elijah Winrod, Prince of Wales Island
- Lena Hensley

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- Mark Tollfedlt, Klawock
- Lief Wilson, Tok
- Doug, Rhodes, Prince of Wales Island
- Michael Kampnich, Craig
- Brian Ridley, Chief/Chairman, Tanana Chiefs Conference
- Amy Jennings, Chair, East Prince of Wales Island Fish & Game Advisory Committee
- Colonel David Egelston, NYS Environmental Conservation Police (retired), Thorne Bay

Oppose

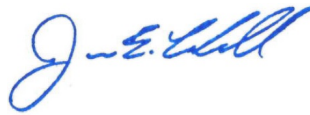
- Mark Richards, Executive Director, Resident Hunters of Alaska (RHAK)
- Bret Bradford, Cordova
- Gary L. Hollier, Kenai
- Mark Keller, Anchorage
- Rod Arno, Public Policy Director, Alaska Outdoor Council
- Steve Bradford, snowbird
- Sean O'Brien, Juneau
- Elizabeth Figus, Juneau
- Tom Lovas, Anchorage
- John Dittrich, District 12
- Natalie Bradford, Juneau
- Grey Mitchell, Juneau
- Karl Rodvik, Anchorage
- Dr. Brett A. Barringer, Anchorage
- Jerry Cates, Sterling
- Dana Seagars, Anchorage
- Jack N Hendrickson, Fairbanks
- Ken and Anna Vorisek

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

DPS defers to DFG

Commissioner's Signature: _____



Date: May 16, 2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor's Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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